

8.1 Technologies

Mobiles are based on two distinct connectivity technologies—Global System for Mobile Communications (GSM) and Code Division Multiple Access (CDMA). GSM mobile phone companies were the first to set up their networks in India while CDMA networks are quite recent. For instance, Orange is a GSM service provider while Reliance is a CDMA service provider. At this point, we need not delve into the intricacies of the two different networks. What we do is talk about the technologies used for Internet access in the two different forms of service. Let's start with the GSM type of networks.

GPRS

GPRS is an acronym for General Packet Radio Service. This technology allows information to be sent back and forth across a mobile network. It is an addition to today's Circuit Switched Data (CSD) and Short Message Service (SMS) services. Some of the exclusive features of GPRS are given below:

Speed

The maximum theoretical speed that can be achieved is up to 171.2 kilobits per second (kbps) using all the eight timeslots at the same time. This is approximately three times faster than the currently available fixed telecommunications networks. This may also be cost effective as GPRS allows information to be transferred extremely fast, almost immediately with a high rate of efficiency across a mobile network.

Instantaneous

GPRS lets you stay connected as information can be sent or received immediately as the need arises, depending on the signal strength and coverage. This feature comes into play when you are checking cricket scores on your cell using the Internet or for applications such as online shopping which needs credit card authentication.

Application Development

GPRS lets mobile application developers develop newer, faster and better mobile applications that haven't been available due to